Gmail

Jacob Merlin <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com>

Housing assistance

4 messages

Kimberlee Tutalo <Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au> Thu, Mar 26, 2026 at 4:42 PM
To: "jacobmerlin22@gmail.com" <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com>, "erox93@hotmail.com" <erox93@hotmail.com>

Good afternoon,

I spoke with helpline today after they spoke with Jacob.

They have let me know that your date of termination and possession is next Tuesday 31/03/2026.

As your efforts have been unsuccessful with finding a new rental – I recommended calling 02 6162 6100.

This number is MaryMead Catholic Care, and they might be able to help with some crisis housing for you guys and the little ones.

If you are seeking to contest the decision, there are avenues through ACAT but I am not sure if that will assist as the date of the orders is so soon.

Let me know if you have any questions.

Regards,

Kimberlee Tutalo
Aboriginal Justice Liaison Officer
Community Liaison Unit

Legal Aid ACT

2 Allsop Street Canberra 2601
Phone: 02 6243 3411
Fax: 02 6243 3423
Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au
www.legalaidact.org.au

Legal Aid ACT respectfully acknowledges the traditional land owners whose land we are working on today and pay our respects to Elders past and present. We also acknowledge and pay our respects to the Aboriginal people who draw their ancestral lines from this land.

Please consider the environment - do you really need to print this email?

Jacob Merlin <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com> Fri, Mar 27, 2026 at 11:58 AM
To: Kimberlee Tutalo <Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au>

Dear Kimberlee

Thank you for your response — we truly appreciate your continued support.

As you are aware of the background of our case, we are writing to urgently seek your advice on the following:

The property manager (Jenna, Belle Property) has confirmed they will be applying for a warrant for eviction with the ACAT Registrar on 1 April. The warrant has not yet been issued.

We believe we have strong grounds to return to ACAT, specifically:

- ACAT indicated willingness to grant up to 12 months had we been able to prove our income — we were never given a proper opportunity to do so, as Centrelink was inaccessible from 24 December to 6 January.
- Erinn's postpartum recovery was not adequately considered — this directly cost us the one to two weeks needed for our payments to come into effect.
- Our financial position has since materially changed: Jacob has secured full-time contract work and Erinn has secured Centrelink payments, giving us a combined documented fortnightly income of $2,500.
- We have submitted 18 rental applications (11 declined) and face the Easter long weekend with all services unavailable.

We would like to know:
1. Can we make an urgent application to ACAT to extend the termination date based on the above?
2. Can we seek an interim order to stay the warrant for eviction while this is reviewed?

We are available immediately and understand time is critical.

Kind regards,
Jacob merlin

Jacob Merlin <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com> Fri, Mar 27, 2026 at 12:01 PM
To: Kimberlee Tutalo <Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au>

Sorry i forgot to add,

we asked jenna to extend our stay until the 7th of april and she replied that she will be handing the warrant request in on april the 1st. we are just on a tight deadline and needed more time and that was the response we got so were just trying to do anything we can weve exhausted alot of options maybe acat could give us a better date due to our income changing.

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Kimberlee Tutalo <Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au> Mon, Mar 30, 2026 at 10:05 AM
To: Jacob Merlin <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com>

Good morning,

Thank you for the below response.

As I am not a lawyer, I cannot give you any legal advice regarding the current matter.

I recommended you act on the latest legal advice you and Erinn have received from Georgia last Thursday.

Please let me know if you require any assistance with the MaryMead Catholic Care crisis accommodation onboarding and I will be happy to assist.

Regards,

Kay

Kimberlee Tutalo
Aboriginal Justice Liaison Officer
Community Liaison Unit

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From: Jacob Merlin <jacobmerlin22@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, 27 March 2026 12:02 PM
To: Kimberlee Tutalo <Kimberlee.Tutalo@legalaidact.org.au>
Subject: Re: Housing assistance

> You don't often get email from jacobmerlin22@gmail.com. Learn why this is important

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